FIGHTERBASE

Nordic

Diet guide

Oily fish, rye, berries, root veg.



Prepared 11 October 2026 for FighterBase members. Eating styles library, one of a set.

DRAFT: not yet reviewed by a registered dietitian. General information only, not medical advice. Check with your doctor or a registered dietitian before changing how you eat, especially if you have a medical condition, are pregnant, or are under 18.

USING FIGHTERBASE

How to use this diet guide

This diet guide is part of your eating styles library in the FighterBase app. The pages that follow are built to be skimmed. You do not need to read it all at once.

1. **Open Nutrition**
   In the app, open the **Nutrition** tab and tap **Eating styles**.

2. **Tap Nordic**
   Read the short summary, what to eat, what to go easy on, and what to watch.

3. **Follow it**
   Tap **Follow this style**. Recipes and the Foods list then filter to match, so you only see what fits. You can follow more than one style.

4. **Download the PDFs**
   Use **Full food list** and **Diet guide** to save these to your phone. Handy for the shop or a restaurant.

5. **Log it and train**
   Meals you log count towards your day. Spend your energy on training, not on reading labels.

> Looking for the full list of foods? Download the **Full food list** PDF from the same screen. It names every allowed and avoided food.

THE BASICS

What is Nordic?

Built on traditional Scandinavian foods: oily fish, wholegrain rye and oats, berries, cabbages and root vegetables, and rapeseed oil.

Where it comes from

Developed from traditional foods of Denmark, Sweden, Norway, Finland and Iceland. It emphasises local, seasonal foods and was set out as a diet pattern by Nordic researchers in the early 2000s.

The main ideas

1. More fruit (especially berries), vegetables (especially roots and cabbages) and wholegrains such as rye, oats and barley.
2. Fish and seafood often, especially oily fish.
3. Rapeseed (canola) oil as the main cooking fat.
4. Less red and processed meat; more game and poultry.
5. Low-fat dairy in moderation.
6. Less sugar and fewer sugary drinks.

Who it suits

- People who like hearty, simple food
- People who want a plant-heavy diet that still includes fish
- Anyone looking for a cold-climate, seasonal approach

> **Talk to your doctor or a registered dietitian first if:**
> - You have a fish or gluten allergy or coeliac disease (rye and barley contain gluten)
> - You are pregnant (check fish guidance)

TRAINING

Fuel for training

- Rye bread, oats, barley and potatoes are the carb base around training.
- Herring, salmon and mackerel give protein and omega-3.
- Skyr or quark with berries is a good recovery snack.
- Root vegetables make hearty, cheap pre-training meals.

> Oats and rye for slower-release fuel, potatoes or berries closer to sessions, skyr and fish for recovery.

Nutrients to keep an eye on

Vitamin D
low sunlight in northern winters
Where: oily fish, fortified foods, a supplement in autumn and winter (UK advice)

Iron
less red meat
Where: game, rye, legumes, greens, seafood

Iodine
comes from fish and dairy
Where: white fish, dairy, seaweed in small amounts

Calcium
if dairy is limited
Where: dairy, fortified alternatives, greens

Common mistakes

- Too much cured and pickled fish (very salty)
- Rye bread as the only carb at every meal
- Cutting protein by cutting meat without replacing it
- Forgetting vitamin D in winter

EVERYDAY LIFE

Labels, eating out and swaps

Reading labels

- 'Rye' on a label does not always mean 100% rye bread
- Pickled herring may be high in sugar
- Smoked and cured foods are often high in salt

Eating out

- Look for grilled or baked fish, vegetable soups, open sandwiches on rye.
- Ask for dressings on the side.
- Share a plate of herring, potatoes and pickles.

Easy swaps

White bread	→	Dark rye bread
Sunflower oil	→	Rapeseed oil
Pork sausage	→	Fish cakes or chicken
Cakes	→	Berries and skyr

PUT IT INTO PRACTICE

A sample week

One way a week could look. Portions and total food depend on you and your training.

	Breakfast	Lunch	Dinner
Mon	Oat porridge with berries	Open rye sandwich with smoked mackerel	Baked salmon, boiled potatoes, dill, cabbage
Tue	Skyr, berries, rye crispbread	Pea soup	Chicken, root vegetable mash, greens
Wed	Rye bread, egg, cucumber	Herring, potatoes, beetroot	Cod stew with leeks
Thu	Porridge with apple and cinnamon	Lentil and barley soup	Venison or beef meatballs, potatoes, lingonberries
Fri	Egg and rye toast	Salmon salad	Fish pie with root veg
Sat	Pancakes with berries	Mushroom and barley soup	Roast chicken, carrots, swede
Sun	Smoked fish and eggs on rye	Leftovers bowl	Beef and vegetable stew

Snacks

Berries · Skyr or quark · Rye crispbread with cheese · Apples and nuts · Boiled egg

Shopping list

Rye bread, oats, barley, potatoes · Herring, salmon, mackerel, cod · Cabbages, carrots, swede, beetroot, leeks · Berries (frozen are fine) · Skyr or quark, eggs · Rapeseed oil

GOOD TO KNOW

Questions people ask

Is it hard in the UK?

No. Most of it is available in supermarkets: rye bread, frozen berries, oily fish, skyr, oats and root vegetables.

Further reading

Nordic Council of Ministers; Danish SYSDIET studies; NHS.



For fighters and combat athletes

- **No eating style makes a rapid weight cut safe.** Sweating, fluid restriction and crash diets hurt performance and can be dangerous. Plan any weight cut with a registered sports dietitian and your coach, well before the weigh-in.
- **Fuel the training first.** Hard sparring and conditioning need carbohydrate and enough total food. If a style cuts a food group, have a plan to replace what is lost.
- **Protein across the day.** A common general range for people training hard is about 1.4 to 2.0 g per kg of body weight a day (draft range, to be confirmed by a dietitian).
- **Try changes in training, never in fight week.** Test new foods, supplements and timing well before competition.
- **Under 18, pregnant, or with a medical condition:** get advice from a doctor or dietitian before changing your diet.

FIGHTERBASE

Train. Eat. Recover. Repeat.

Your eating styles library lives in the Nutrition tab. Pick a style, follow it, and get back to training.

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